A Life for a Life

Leviticus 1–7 · Leviticus 17:11

The big idea: Sin brings death, and in mercy God accepted a substitute. The worshiper laid his hand on the animal: this life stands in my place. The offerings cover the whole of life with God, and they point to Jesus, who bore our sins in his body.

Before you meet: Read

Leviticus 1:1–9 · Leviticus 3:1–5 · Leviticus 17:11 · Psalm 51:16–17

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever tried to make up for something you did wrong? How did you know when you had done enough?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"For the life of the flesh is in the _____, and I have given it for you on the altar to make _____ for your souls." *(Leviticus 17:11)*

"He shall lay his _____ on the head of the burnt offering, and it shall be accepted for him to make atonement for him." *(Leviticus 1:4)*

"The sacrifices of God are a broken _____; a broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not _____." *(Psalm 51:17)*

Discuss

1. What was your first reaction to all the blood in Leviticus? How does a life for a life change the way you see it? *Leviticus 17:11; Romans 6:23*

2. The worshiper laid his hand on the animal and then killed it himself. Why do you think God designed it that way? *Leviticus 1:3–5*

3. Most of the peace offering was eaten by the worshiper's household "before the LORD." Why do you think sacrifice ended in a meal? *Leviticus 7:15; Deuteronomy 12:7*

Memory verse

> *"He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we might die to sin and live to righteousness."*
>
> **1 Peter 2:24**

Pray

Thank Jesus by name for taking your place. Ask God for a broken and contrite heart, and for worship that never becomes routine.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 21

A Life for a Life

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Leviticus 1:1–9 and 17:11 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Leviticus 10:1–3 and 16).

Main points to land

1. Sin is rebellion against the source of life, and its wages is death. In mercy God accepted a substitute: the laid-on hand meant this animal stands in my place (Leviticus 1:4; 17:11).
2. The five offerings cover all of life with God: guilt removed, devotion given, thanks offered, and fellowship enjoyed. The peace offering ended at a table, because the goal of atonement is fellowship with God.
3. God never wanted sacrifice without repentance. The animal on the altar was meant to go with a broken and contrite heart (Ps. 51:17; Hos. 6:6).

Answer key (Observe)

1. blood; atonement
2. hand
3. spirit; despise

Questions people will ask

Why would God want animals killed? And did those sacrifices actually work?
Sacrifice showed in blood what sin costs and that God would accept a substitute. Hebrews says animal blood could never take away sins (10:4), yet Leviticus says the worshiper was forgiven (4:31). Both are true: believing Israelites were forgiven by faith in the promised Messiah, the sacrifices being God's signs pointing to Christ (WCF 7.5; 8.6). Now that he has come, no more sacrifices are needed.

Closing prayer

Father, our sin deserves death, and you accepted a substitute. Thank you for Jesus, the spotless one who laid down his life of his own accord. Give us broken and contrite hearts, and bring us to your table in peace. Amen.

Full study with illustrations and diagrams: 490.life/bible-study